# It’s an emergency!

TASK 1

## What would you do?

**Answer** the questions with a partner. Give reasons.

English File Upper-intermediate, Student’s Book p. 44, ex 1a

TASK 2

## How do you eat an elephant?

**Guess** the answer with your partner. What do you think it means in an emergency?

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student’s Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 3

## Read the article

**Read** the article on p. 45. **Answer** the questions.

1. What is the key to surviving a life-or-death crisis?

2. What is the 10-80-10 principle?

3. Apart from keeping calm, what else is important?

Adapted from: Latham-Koenig, C. and Oxenden, C. (2014) *English File Upper-intermediate Student's Book*, 3rd edn. Oxford: Oxford University Press. File 5A, pp. 44–45 and the Communication pages. Tasks 2, 8 and 9: Ramy Sakr, for Connect Lite (2026).

TASK 4

# Words from the article

**Find** the highlighted words in the article. **Match** them to the meanings.

**English File Upper-intermediate, Student's Book p. 45, 'How to eat an elephant'**

1. unable to react because the situation is too strong _____
2. so shocked that you can't think clearly or act _____
3. a new or difficult thing that tests your abilities _____
4. very confused _____
5. based on reason, not emotion _____
6. to succeed in dealing with a problem _____
7. to not get excited or nervous; not to panic _____
8. pieces of work you are able to deal with _____

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TASK 5

# Strong feelings

**Listen** to the dialogues. **Choose** the stressed syllable in each adjective. Then practise the dialogues with a partner.

**English File Upper-intermediate, Student's Book p. 45, ex 3 (dialogues); audio track 3.5**

**Track 3.5 · the dialogues**
Your teacher will play the recording.

1. **desperate** _____
2. **offended** _____
3. **disappointed** _____
4. **bewildered** _____
5. **astonished** _____
6. **delighted** _____
7. **devastated** _____
8. **horrified** _____
9. **overwhelmed** _____

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TASK 6

# It's an emergency!

**In threes:** you are A, B or C. Read **only your text**. Note what you should and shouldn't do, and why.

## Student A · an emergency on a plane

Your text: English File Upper-intermediate, File 5A, Communication pages

| YOU SHOULD… | YOU SHOULDN'T… |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |

## Student B · lost on a hike in the mountains

Your text: English File Upper-intermediate, File 5A, Communication pages

| YOU SHOULD… | YOU SHOULDN'T… |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |

## Student C · somebody breaks into your house

Your text: English File Upper-intermediate, File 5A, Communication pages

| YOU SHOULD… | YOU SHOULDN'T… |
| --- | --- |
| | |
| | |
| | |

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TASK 7

## Tell your group

**In your own words**, tell the others how to survive your emergency. Don't read. They listen and ask one question each.

Use: *The most important thing is… · You should never… · Experts say… · If you…, you'll…*

TASK 8

## The rules of survival

**In groups,** rank the rules from 1 (most important) to 8. You must all agree.

| | |
|---|---|
| Stay calm and breathe. | _____ |
| Have a plan before anything happens. | _____ |
| Stay where you are and wait for help. | _____ |
| Tell someone where you are going. | _____ |
| Do one thing at a time. | _____ |
| Always carry water and a phone. | _____ |
| Trust your instincts. | _____ |
| Never try to be a hero. | _____ |

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TASK 9

## What now?

**In groups:** choose an emergency. Plan exactly what you would do, step by step. Then **tell the class**. The class decides: would you survive?

You are stuck in a lift with five strangers. The alarm doesn't work.

Your kitchen is on fire and the smoke is getting thick.

You lose your little cousin at a big music festival.

Your car breaks down on a desert road at night, with no phone signal.

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